



July 9, 2026

VIA ECFS

Marlene H. Dortch
Secretary
Federal Communications Commission
45 L Street N.E.
Washington, DC 20554

Re: Written *Ex Parte* Submission in Facilitating Implementation of Next Generation 9-1-1 Services (NG9-1-1), PS Docket No. 21-479; Next Generation 9-1-1 (NG9-1-1) Valid Requests, PS Docket No. 25-143

Dear Ms. Dortch:

Pursuant to Section 1.1206 of the rules of the Federal Communications Commission (“Commission”),¹ Intrado Life & Safety, Inc. (“Intrado”) submits this letter in response to the *ex parte* memorandum filed by the Massachusetts State 9-1-1 Department (the “MA State 9-1-1 Authority”) on June 25, 2026 (“MA June 25 *ex parte*”).² Intrado reiterates its support for the Verizon Petition for Waiver³ and remains committed to working with the Commonwealth, Comtech (the Commonwealth’s Next Generation Core Service Provider), and the originating service providers (“OSPs”) that Intrado serves, to complete deployment of reliable Next Generation 9-1-1 (NG9-1-1) services in Massachusetts as soon as possible.

The MA June 25 *ex parte* repeats several assertions that are not correct, and Intrado writes to correct the record on the points below. Further, the Commonwealth continues to escalate Phase 2 issues, which are neither applicable nor within the scope of Verizon’s Phase 1 waiver request. It is unnecessary for the Public Safety and Homeland Security Bureau (“Bureau” or “PSHSB”) to resolve the Phase 2 questions here to deal fully with Verizon’s waiver request.

I. Intrado Does Not Provide Private Switch/Automatic Location Identification (“PS/ALI”) Service in Massachusetts.

Intrado does not provide PS/ALI service in Massachusetts, and the MA State 9-1-1 Authority is incorrect to suggest otherwise.⁴ PS/ALI is a legacy, Time-Division Multiplexing (“TDM”)-based Multi-line Telephone Service (“MLTS”) 9-1-1 solution. The PS/ALI routing issue described in the Verizon Petition arises among Verizon, Verizon’s customers (who are responsible for maintaining their own location records), and Comtech (which is the ALI provider under

¹ 47 C.F.R. § 1.1206.

² Notice of *Ex Parte*, Massachusetts State 9-1-1 Department, PS Docket No. 21-479 (filed June 25, 2026) (“MA June 25 *ex parte*”).

³ Verizon Petition for Waiver, PS Docket No. 21-479 (filed Apr. 17, 2026) (“Verizon Petition”); *see also* Public Safety and Homeland Security Bureau Seeks Comment on Verizon Petition for Waiver of Next Generation 9-1-1 (NG9-1-1) Phase 1 Deadlines, Public Notice, DA 26-407 (PSHSB Apr. 24, 2026).

⁴ *See* MA June 25 *ex parte* at 3; *see also* Massachusetts State 9-1-1 Department Response to and Comments on Verizon Petition for Waiver, PS Dkt. No. 21-479, at 7-8 (filed May 4, 2026).

contract with Verizon to provide ALI for Verizon's legacy PS/ALI service).⁵ *Intrado does not transport Verizon's legacy wireline 9-1-1 traffic* and, therefore, has no role in the provision of Verizon's legacy PS/ALI service in Massachusetts.

What Intrado offers in Massachusetts is an IP-based Voice over Internet Protocol ("VoIP") and MLTS 9-1-1 solution, which is a next-generation successor to the legacy PS/ALI solution. Intrado's solution works today in the transitional environment, alongside the legacy ALI and MSAG systems. It is built to deliver full i3 Phase 1 and 2 capability for both VoIP- and IP-based MLTS, once an OSP customer procures and implements Intrado's NG9-1-1 NEXUS solution.

The point at which Intrado will begin serving Verizon with this IP-based 9-1-1 solution is when Verizon moves its wireline records onto the Intrado NEXUS platform. Casting Intrado as Verizon's current PS/ALI provider confuses a legacy TDM service that Intrado does not offer with the IP-based service that Intrado does provide. This distinction is critical.

II. Intrado Does Not Transport Verizon's Legacy Wireline 9-1-1 Traffic, and the State's "Triple Aggregation" Characterization Does Not Properly Describe the Call Delivery Pathway.

Intrado does not transport Verizon's legacy wireline 9-1-1 traffic. Verizon does this, over its own network, and it will continue to control (and have responsibility for) that traffic until Verizon moves those records onto Intrado's IP-based VoIP and MLTS systems and NEXUS platform.

Nevertheless, the MA June 25 *ex parte* claims that "Verizon is using Intrado[,], who in turn is using Sinch's ESGW, who in turn is connecting through Inteliquent's Department-funded last mile egress. This is an example of triple aggregation."⁶ This "triple aggregation" description: (1) mischaracterizes the current call path; (2) ascribes to Intrado a role it does not play, because *Intrado does not transport Verizon's legacy wireline 9-1-1 traffic*; and (3) misstates the structure of Intrado's involvement in the transport of Verizon's wireline traffic once records are transferred to the NEXUS platform.⁷ As explained, *Intrado does not transport Verizon's legacy wireline traffic*; the MA State 9-1-1 Authority is not correct that Intrado is part of Verizon's current, legacy wireline transport chain in Massachusetts. Therefore, concerns about levels of aggregation for Verizon legacy wireline traffic have nothing to do with Intrado.

Additionally, the Commonwealth's argument that Intrado is causing the Commonwealth to incur unnecessary costs has no merit. Intrado recognizes that, under the Commission's rules, OSPs are obligated to pay the cost of bringing traffic to the 911 Authority-designated NG911 delivery points.⁸ In Massachusetts, the Commonwealth first instructed OSPs and their vendors that

⁵ See Verizon Petition at 7-8; *see also* Reply Comments of Intrado Life & Safety, Inc., PS Docket Nos. 21-479, 25-143, at 5 (filed May 11, 2026) ("Intrado Reply").

⁶ See MA June 25 *ex parte* at 3.

⁷ See *id.*

⁸ See 47 CFR § 9.33(a).

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connecting to Sinch would establish compliance, and Intrado—at its own cost—subscribed to the Sinch ESGW service to reach the Massachusetts Points of Interconnection (“POIs”).

Based on Sinch’s written representations to Intrado, which Intrado has provided in the public record, the ESGW service to which Intrado currently subscribes is not State-funded. We have no visibility into the call path once we deliver traffic to the Sinch aggregation point. Therefore, we cannot comment on the Commonwealth’s concerns regarding last-mile connections of this service. This issue is something that the Commonwealth must address with its vendor, Sinch.

We purchase a service that carries OSP traffic in SIP to Massachusetts’ previously endorsed aggregator, to reach the Commonwealth’s designated POIs. This established compliance with the FCC’s NG9-1-1 Phase 1 rules.

However, months after establishing Phase 1 compliance in Massachusetts, we learned indirectly that the Commonwealth and/or Comtech were terminating their contract with Sinch for the statewide 9-1-1 aggregation. Subsequently, we learned the Commonwealth no longer considered the Sinch ESGW to be Phase 1 compliant because of the legacy elements and costs involved in the Sinch/Inteliquent 9-1-1 aggregation network not made visible to ESGW customers like Intrado. Taken to its logical conclusion, the Commonwealth is arguing that an OSP can fall out of compliance if the 9-1-1 Authority decides to make a change in its network after the OSP has established compliance. We do not see a basis in the *NG9-1-1 Transition Order* to support this position and, at a minimum, such change in network preference should restart the six-month deadline for Phase 1 compliance.⁹

Nevertheless, based on this after-the-fact change in network preference by the Commonwealth, Intrado is moving off of the ESGW service and onto direct IP circuits. When the Verizon traffic migrates to Intrado, Intrado intends to carry it over these direct IP connections, not over the Sinch path. The Commonwealth is not bearing the cost for any part of this change in Intrado’s connectivity.

III. Intrado Adopted the Sinch ESGW Path Because the Commonwealth Recognized It as a Valid SIP Ingress Pathway to the MA State 9-1-1 Authority’s ESInet and the Subsequent Shift to Requiring Direct Connectivity Warrants Additional Time to Deploy.

As discussed, Intrado purchased and implemented the Sinch ESGW solution because it was a recognized, valid ingress pathway for reaching the MA State 9-1-1 Authority’s 9-1-1 network. This pathway was deemed valid from the time of the Phase 1 RFS in April 2025 through some point in 2026, when the MA State 9-1-1 Authority designated it as non-compliant (we believe, due to ongoing Sinch invoices). Intrado and other 9-1-1 vendors and OSPs connected through Sinch in

⁹ Intrado agrees with Verizon’s position that a change of this nature merits additional time to deploy. See Letter to Marlene Dortch, Secretary, Federal Communications Commission, from Robert Morse, Associate General Counsel, Verizon, PS Docket No. 21-479, at 3 (filed July 7, 2026) (emphasizing that a 9-1-1 Authority’s decision to change their delivery points should “warrant flexibility” regarding implementation timelines and “should arguably re-start the six-month Phase 1 deployment timetable” for OSPs).

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reliance on that same understanding of the MA State 9-1-1 Authority's aggregation approach, either through use of Sinch ESGW or some other Sinch service.

The Commonwealth's suggestion in the MA June 25 *ex parte* that Intrado misrepresented the Sinch ESGW connectivity is wrong. Intrado reported in the record of this proceeding exactly what Sinch confirmed to it in writing, which is the same as what the MA State 9-1-1 Authority staff told Intrado on April 23, 2026.¹⁰ On the funding question, Intrado knows only what Sinch has represented. Sinch confirmed in writing that "the state is not funding" the ESGW service and that Sinch is "delivering to the state of MA POIs listed in their Phase 1 letter."¹¹ Intrado is a customer of Sinch's ESGW service, not the operator of the service, and has no independent visibility into Sinch's underlying circuits.

Intrado further understands that Sinch has engaged directly with both the Bureau and the Commonwealth on the ESGW and last mile issues and has proposed to absorb the disputed costs, a proposal that the Commonwealth has indicated it will accept. Sinch is best positioned to confirm the particulars on the record. The governing legal premise is also clear. Under the Commission's *NG9-1-1 Transition Order* and Part 9 rules, an OSP that uses an aggregation service to route 9-1-1 traffic to a 9-1-1 Authority's designated POIs in the required IP-based SIP format meets its obligations under the Commission's rules.¹²

The more important point is the impact of the State's change of course. Intrado has no objection to direct connectivity and has already moved to deploy it. But the State did not impose a direct connectivity requirement until after the October 2025 Phase 1 compliance date that it now seeks to enforce.¹³ As Intrado understands it, around December 2025, the MA State 9-1-1 Authority, Sinch and/or Comtech began notifying OSPs that the MA State 9-1-1 Authority had decided to terminate the Sinch aggregation arrangement it once endorsed. Despite the fact that Intrado and the MA State 9-1-1 Authority have been meeting monthly for over one year, the MA State 9-1-1 Authority did not inform Intrado (or, as far as we know, our OSP customers) that it now considered the Sinch ESGW service to be Phase 1 non-compliant. We learned this in the context of this waiver proceeding.

In fact, on April 23, 2026, the MA State 9-1-1 Authority staff and Comtech told Intrado the opposite, which was reinforced by Sinch's email on May 5, 2026.¹⁴ Given this after-the-fact change in network preference, the MA State 9-1-1 Authority should not be permitted to penalize—or have the Bureau penalize—Intrado, or any other OSP or 9-1-1 vendor, for the Commonwealth's *post hoc* change of heart.¹⁵

¹⁰ See Intrado Reply at 3 & n.6.

¹¹ See *id.* at Exhibit A (Email from Josh Burch, Sr. Director, Emergency Services Operations, Sinch, to Sean Ward, Intrado, dated May 5, 2026).

¹² See *NG9-1-1 Transition Order*, 39 FCC Rcd 8137, 8199, para. 139 (2024); see also 47 C.F.R. §§ 9.29(a), 9.33(a)(1).

¹³ See MA June 25 *ex parte* at 2.

¹⁴ See Intrado Reply at 3.

¹⁵ This is not an Intrado problem alone. Many carriers currently rely on Sinch to reach the Massachusetts 9-1-1 network. Sinch is also the path to Comtech's ESInet, and to other ESInet providers in several other states.

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For Intrado specifically, the connectivity question will soon be moot. Intrado has already secured one of its two direct circuits to the Commonwealth's designated NG9-1-1 POI, and we are approximately two to four weeks from establishing the other one. Once those circuits are in service, Intrado will migrate all customer traffic—including Verizon's—to these direct connections.

This issue has greater implications; aggregation is a common and accepted model.¹⁶ Many OSPs currently rely on Sinch to reach the Massachusetts 9-1-1 network, and Sinch is also the preferred path in several other states serviced by a Comtech ESInet or other ESInet providers (including NGA911 and Motorola). The MA State 9-1-1 Authority's decision to displace Sinch on short notice will create the same problem and delay for many other OSPs that it created for Intrado.

IV. Phase 2 Is Outside the Scope of the Verizon Petition and, In Any Event, Depends on i3 Capabilities Massachusetts Does Not Have.

Phase 2 is outside the scope of Verizon's Petition seeking Phase 1 relief, and it is not clear why the Commonwealth continues to fold Phase 2 issues into this Phase 1 proceeding. The Bureau should decline to resolve Phase 2 compliance questions here and should reserve them for a proceeding in which they are actually implicated.¹⁷

On the merits, and as Intrado has explained, Phase 2 is far more complex than Phase 1. It depends on technical interoperability and on the Commonwealth's own 9-1-1 system meeting commonly accepted NG9-1-1 standards, which the Commonwealth has identified as the NENA i3 standard. The Massachusetts system does not meet these standards. It cannot display Location by Value ("LbV"), it cannot display location in Civic Location Data Exchange Format ("CLDXF"), and it cannot receive Real Time Text ("RTT").¹⁸ These are core elements of a working i3 system. The Commonwealth must be aware of the status of its system because it has an open Request for Proposals for an i3-capable call handling equipment ("CHE") system, and therefore, remains roughly two years away from deploying i3 capable CHE across its PSAPs.¹⁹

These gaps call into question the validity of the Commonwealth's Phase 2 RFS certification. Under the FCC's rules, for a Phase 2 request to be valid, a 9-1-1 Authority must certify under Section 9.31(b) of the Commission's rules that it has installed and placed into operation the infrastructure needed to receive and process Phase 2 traffic and that it has obtained the commitments needed to complete connectivity testing.²⁰ A State that maintains CHE that

¹⁶ It seems as if the Commonwealth may also be arguing that "triple aggregation" is somehow unreliable service because of the number of hops. *See* MA June 25 *ex parte* at 3. Intrado does not offer an opinion on this issue because we are not involved in such a call path in Massachusetts.

¹⁷ *See* Intrado Reply at 6.

¹⁸ *See id.* at 10-13.

¹⁹ *See id.* at 12 n.23.

²⁰ *See* 47 C.F.R. § 9.31(b).

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cannot process LbV and with an ESInet that does not support RTT cannot truthfully certify that it has met the requirements of Section 9.31(b) of the Commission's rules.²¹

Last, the Commonwealth's MLTS non-compliance registry is a matter of state MLTS regulation and has no bearing on Intrado's role under the Commission's NG9-1-1 transition framework.

V. Intrado Is Moving Forward to Deploy Phase 2 Despite the State's i3 Gaps and Encourages the Bureau to Recognize the Need for Flexibility During the Nation's First Phase 2 Implementation and to Encourage Collaboration Over Unhelpful Finger-Pointing.

Despite all this, Intrado is doing the work to make Phase 2 function on a state system that does not meet the i3 standard designated by the Commonwealth. Intrado, at its cost, is developing code to add both LbV and Location by Reference ("LbR") to every VoIP record on the NEXUS platform. It will perform LVF validation, even though the Commonwealth's CHE will continue for some time to display location in MSAG format and cannot use the full CLDXF format prescribed by NG9-1-1 commonly accepted standards.²² Intrado is willing to carry that additional burden to ensure that deployment moves forward in Massachusetts, and it is entirely reasonable to expect the Commonwealth to act in the same spirit of cooperation and for the Bureau to recognize the extraordinary (and costly) measures that Intrado has undertaken to ensure Phase 2 deployment is completed in Massachusetts as soon as practicable and without undue delay.

Intrado's currently projected Phase 2 schedule for its Massachusetts VoIP records presumes that the pending direct circuit connectivity is available within four weeks and that the Commonwealth's NGCS vendor confirms its availability to test.²³ Based on these assumptions, Intrado's Phase 2 deployment schedule is as follows:

- Projected readiness for static VoIP records, which make up 90% to 95% of the records that will be on Intrado's platform, is September/October 2026.
- Projected readiness for the remaining 5% to 10%, which are dynamic VoIP records, is December 2026/January 2027.

As we have said before in this proceeding, the Commonwealth should recognize that Intrado cannot compel any OSP to purchase or deploy our NEXUS service. Not every OSP is an Intrado customer, not every current Intrado customer has purchased NG9-1-1 service through

²¹ See Intrado Reply at 12-13 (citing *In the Matter of the Transition from TTY to Real-Time Text Technology*, Order, 32 FCC Rcd 9316, ¶¶ 1, 7-8 (PSHSB and CGB, Nov. 3, 2017)). We read Commission precedent to say that the missing RTT support is more than an i3 gap; it rests with the State and its ESInet, and it carries accessibility obligations that fall on the ESInet provider and the State, not on OSPs.

²² See *id.* at 13.

²³ Because this is Intrado's first Phase 2 implementation with a State 9-1-1 Authority and its first implementation on a Comtech ESInet and end-of-life CallWorks CHE that is beyond its maintenance support term, we are currently pursuing a lab-to-prod testing environment with Comtech. While the State 9-1-1 Authority has endorsed prod-to-prod testing, we strongly advise against that approach here, given the high likelihood of the need for subsequent coding changes that would require multiple software releases that would significantly slow the implementation timeline.

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NEXUS, and some OSPs provision their own service or use other vendors.²⁴ We make our NEXUS solution available and market it to OSPs to advance adoption. This is also to say that some noncompliance in Massachusetts will persist after Intrado fully deploys NEXUS.

For these reasons, and those in Intrado's Reply Comments, Intrado urges the Bureau to take a measured view of the timeline and not enforce a deadline that the Commonwealth's own system and its late change in direction have made impossible for OSPs and their vendors to meet. The Bureau should grant the Verizon Petition and decline to resolve Phase 2 compliance questions outside the scope of this Phase 1 waiver proceeding. Intrado will continue to work in good faith with the Commonwealth, Comtech, and Intrado's OSP customers toward a durable solution. We appreciate the opportunity to present our views on these important matters.

Respectfully submitted,

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²⁴ It is unclear if any 9-1-1 VPC vendors or VoIP carriers other than Sinch are currently leveraging the MA State 9-1-1 Authority's LVF. Based on Sinch's recent social media posts, our understanding is that Sinch believes it is currently the only 9-1-1 VPC vendor that has achieved Phase 2 compliance for some portion of its VoIP 9-1-1 traffic in Massachusetts via reliance on its purportedly non-compliant aggregation network (which arguably renders its Phase 2 implementation non-compliant as well).

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